
CONFIDENTIAL · TECHNICAL BRIEF v2

Westbound Studios

Revenue Engines + Sammy Rane Production Stack

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Structure: Westbound Studios LLC — 50/50 Equity

The build that turns a single songwriter and a single engineer into a multi-channel AI music label.
Three revenue engines. One flagship artist. One bond — 50/50 partners day one.

01 · OVERVIEW

Executive Summary

This brief defines what we are building together at Westbound Studios — a two-layer AI music label that runs on automation, compounds over time, and gives a flagship artist (Sammy Rane and Westbound) a real shot at cultural traction. One engineer (you), one creative lead (Dan), 50/50 equity partners in the LLC.

The structure

Layer 1 — Practical Revenue Engines. Three automated channels that generate compounding income whether or not any single artist breaks. This is the floor. This is the infrastructure that pays the bills, funds the studio, and de-risks the entire operation.

Layer 2 — The Creative Swing. Sammy Rane and Westbound — a fully AI-generated rock act with a serialized rockumentary series, monthly song releases, and the potential to break into real cultural relevance. This is the ceiling. This is where the lottery ticket lives.

The numbers, honest

\$185K – \$1M	~\$400 / mo	2 people
3-YEAR REVENUE FLOOR-TO-CEILING	TOTAL TOOL COST TO RUN EVERYTHING	DAN (CREATIVE) + UG (ENGINEERING)

Why this works

Sync and YouTube are the real compounding engines. Every track and every video earns forever. Sammy Rane is the upside swing — could be zero, could be a cultural moment. The empire works because the boring channels carry the rent and the creative swing carries the dream.

You are not an employee. You are a co-founder. 50/50 equity partners in Westbound Studios LLC from day one. Year 1 split is 60/40 (Dan gets the extra 20% to recoup pre-build investment). Year 2 onward, every dollar splits 50/50 forever.

02 · STRATEGY

The Two Layers

Most AI music projects do one thing — either crank out faceless catalog or chase one artist. Westbound runs both at once because they share the same infrastructure. Same Suno account. Same n8n workflows. Same engineer. The practical channels fund the operation. The creative swing makes it worth getting up for.

LAYER 1	LAYER 2
The Practical Channels Three revenue engines designed to compound. Faceless, automated, and built to earn even when nobody is paying attention. This is the floor of the business — the income that pays for everything regardless of whether any artist breaks. What it earns: Year 1: \$28K – \$38K Year 2: \$105K – \$145K Year 3: \$210K – \$295K Effort: Mostly automated. ~1 hr/day curation, weekly admin. Risk profile: Low. Spread across 3 channels.	The Creative Swing Sammy Rane and Westbound — a fully AI-generated post-grunge act with a serialized rockumentary series. Monthly song drops. Weekly episodes. Real story, real wounds, real characters. The upside is fame, IP licensing, a cultural moment. What it could earn: Year 1: \$0 – \$25K Year 2: \$5K – \$200K Year 3: \$20K – \$650K+ Effort: Weekly creative work, story arcs, song releases. Risk profile: Binary. Real or lottery.

GOAL CEILING — 3-YEAR EMPIRE TOTAL \$185K floor · \$1M+ ceiling Floor assumes consistent execution on the three practical channels with Sammy Rane at modest traction. Realistic case is \$370K–\$680K. Ceiling assumes one breakthrough — an artist that hits Velvet Sundown territory, a sync placement on a major show, or the rockumentary IP gets licensed.
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03.1 · REVENUE ENGINE

Sync Library + Signal Engine

The main earner. Film, TV, ad, and YouTube licensing — driven by real-time demand.

HONEST CAVEAT Sync platforms are tightening AI policies in 2026. Expect 20–40% rejection on premium platforms (Musicbed, Artlist). Plan on Songtradr + Pond5 + AudioJungle as base, treat premium as upside. Disclosure is mandatory — we position as 'AI-assisted, human-curated.'

What it is

An automated factory that generates targeted instrumental tracks and matches them to live demand signals — Songtradr briefs, trending TikTok sounds, Tunefind placements. We do not spray and pray. We build to demand. Music supervisors search, find our tracks, license for \$200–\$2,000 per placement (sometimes \$5K–\$50K on big placements). Every placement earns lifetime residuals.

Architecture

- **Stage 1 — Signal scrapers (n8n):** Songtradr Briefs, Music Gateway, Taxi, Tunefind, WhatSong, TikTok trending API » daily demand dump
- **Stage 2 — Prompt generator (Claude API):** Converts demand signals into detailed Suno prompts (mood, BPM, instruments, references)
- **Stage 3 — Generation (Suno API):** 4 variations per prompt, auto-filtered for length, vocals, clipping
- **Stage 4 — Metadata + tagging (Claude API):** Auto-tags BPM, key, mood, genre, 'sounds like,' use cases — every track gets a full schema
- **Stage 5 — Multi-platform upload:** Songtradr, Pond5, AudioJungle, Artlist (if accepted), DistroKid for DSP instrumental albums
- **Stage 6 — Brief auto-submission:** Match new tracks to active briefs within 24 hours — this is the unlock

BUILD TIME	RUN COST	DAN'S TIME
4–6 weeks	~\$200 / mo	1 hr/day curation

	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	YEAR 3
Realistic monthly exit rate	\$2K – \$4K by Mo 12	\$6K – \$10K	\$12K – \$18K
Annual revenue range	\$20K – \$25K	\$75K – \$90K	\$150K – \$180K

The moat

Anyone can generate AI music. Almost nobody is building the demand-signal layer that matches output to live supervisor briefs. That is your moat. Brief submission converts at 10–50× passive catalog rate. The signal engine is the differentiator — not the music.

Your contribution (UG)

This is the most technically interesting build in the empire. n8n orchestration across 7+ APIs, signal aggregation from public and scraped sources, Claude prompt-engineering at scale, and a custom ranking/matching algorithm. Portfolio-grade work.

03.2 · REVENUE ENGINE

YouTube Faceless Music Channels

Five themed long-form channels — ambient, lofi, rain rock, campfire country, etc.

HONEST CAVEAT Months 1–4 = \$0. Each channel needs 1K subs and 4K watch hours to monetize. Once over the threshold, it compounds fast. Pure AI faceless channels need 'human creative input' to stay monetized in 2026 — the voiced intro solves this.

What it is

Five themed YouTube channels each publishing one 1–3 hour AI music video daily. Static or slow-motion visuals matched to mood. Monetized via YouTube ad revenue plus Content ID through Identifyy. Reuses the Suno output from Engine 1 — no extra music generation needed.

Architecture

- **Stage 1 — Theme mapping:** Pull mood-tagged tracks from Engine 1 catalog by channel theme
- **Stage 2 — Long-form assembly (Creatomate):** Stitch 20–30 tracks into 1-hour video with static or slow-motion visual loop
- **Stage 3 — Visual library (Midjourney + Kling):** 200 pre-made mood loops built once, reused forever (rain window, neon city, sunrise highway, dim bar)
- **Stage 4 — Human intro layer:** 10-second voiced intro ('Welcome to Rain Rock — 60 minutes of...') to satisfy 2026 YouTube monetization rules
- **Stage 5 — Auto-publish (n8n + YouTube API):** Daily schedule across all 5 channels, metadata + thumbnail + description automated
- **Stage 6 — Content ID claims (Identifyy):** Catches re-uploads of our tracks anywhere on YouTube, claims the revenue

BUILD TIME	RUN COST	DAN'S TIME
1–2 weeks (after Engine 1)	+\$60 / mo	30 min/week

	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	YEAR 3
Realistic monthly exit rate	\$500 – \$2K by Mo 12	\$2K – \$5K	\$4K – \$10K
Annual revenue range	\$5K – \$15K	\$25K – \$50K	\$50K – \$100K

The moat

Lofi Girl proved one channel can hit \$27K/month. Five channels in different lanes means we are not betting on one viral moment — we are building a portfolio. Every old video keeps earning forever once monetized. Pure compounding.

Your contribution (UG)

Creatomate template engineering, YouTube API scheduling, Content ID integration, and visual loop generation pipeline. Plus the dashboard to monitor 5 channels at once. Solid systems work.

03.3 · REVENUE ENGINE

Multi-Artist DSP Catalog

Passive streaming royalties across Sammy Rane, future artists, and the library.

HONEST CAVEAT Streaming pays fractions of pennies. 50K streams ≈ \$200. Realistic without a breakout is small — but it's \$0 effort after release. Pure passive. The breakout scenario is what makes this matter.

What it is

Every song from Sammy Rane and Westbound — plus future artists (Shane Hollis, Cole Renner, Wyatt Brogan) — goes onto Spotify, Apple Music, Tidal, Amazon, YouTube Music, and every other DSP. Each song earns streaming royalties forever. Plus publishing royalties via Songtrust and YouTube Content ID via Identifyy.

Architecture

- **Stage 1 — Release pipeline (DistroKid):** Automated multi-DSP distribution, ISRC + UPC assigned
- **Stage 2 — Publishing (Songtrust):** Registers compositions for mechanical and performance royalties globally
- **Stage 3 — Content ID (Identifyy):** YouTube Content ID across every song, claims ad revenue on re-uploads
- **Stage 4 — Playlist pitching:** Submit to Spotify editorial 7+ days before release, plus 50+ indie playlist curators per release
- **Stage 5 — Royalty aggregation dashboard:** Pulls earnings from DistroKid, Songtrust, Identifyy into one view

BUILD TIME	RUN COST		DAN'S TIME
2–3 days	\$123 / year		Zero after release

	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	YEAR 3
Realistic monthly exit rate	\$50 – \$200	\$300 – \$1K	\$700 – \$2K
Annual revenue range	\$500 – \$2K	\$3K – \$10K	\$8K – \$25K

The moat

This is the smallest channel in normal cases — and the biggest if Sammy breaks. Velvet Sundown hit 1M+ Spotify listeners as an AI act. If Sammy Rane gets to even a third of that, this becomes the engine that funds everything. Lottery ticket built into the structure.

Your contribution (UG)

Lightest build — DistroKid + Songtrust + Identifyy already have great APIs and dashboards. Your job is the playlist pitching automation and the unified royalty dashboard. Maybe 2 days.

03 · COMBINED

Revenue Engines — Combined

Combined output across all three practical channels. Sammy Rane revenue (Layer 2) is layered on top of this — those numbers are not included below. Fiverr was cut: race to the bottom, \$50 jobs, hand-touch per order. Same buyers end up in the Sync Library anyway.

	Floor	Realistic	Ceiling
Year 1 total revenue	\$12K	\$28K – \$38K	\$75K
Year 2 total revenue	\$55K	\$105K – \$145K	\$240K
Year 3 total revenue	\$115K	\$210K – \$295K	\$485K
3-year cumulative	\$182K	\$343K – \$478K	\$800K
+ Sammy Rane upside (Layer 2)	\$0 – \$25K	\$25K – \$200K	\$200K – \$650K+
EMPIRE 3-YEAR TOTAL	\$185K	\$370K – \$680K	\$1M+

Build sequence

Don't build them all at once. Order matters — earlier engines fund the later ones and share infrastructure.

Phase	Months	What gets built	Why now
Phase 1	1 – 2	Sammy Rane production pipeline	Where the excitement is. Build momentum first.
Phase 2	2 – 4	Sync Library + Signal Engine	Biggest revenue contributor long-term. Highest ROI on UG's time.
Phase 3	4 – 5	YouTube Faceless Channels	Reuses Engine 1 output. Near-zero marginal cost.
Ongoing	All	DSP catalog + playlist pitching	Grows naturally as artists release. No big build.

04 · THE CREATIVE SWING

Sammy Rane and Westbound

The flagship act. Modern post-grunge. Seymour, Indiana to Los Angeles.

The artist

Sammy Rane. Early-to-mid 30s. Songwriter and frontman. From Seymour, Indiana — small-town Midwest, rust belt edges. Now based in Los Angeles. Sober. Carrying real wounds and writing through them. Sound is modern Pearl Jam meets Manchester Orchestra meets Highly Suspect — raw, emotional, big choruses, no compromise.

The band

Sammy Rane and Westbound — four members. Westbound is not a backing band, it's a name with weight: leaving, direction, never quite arriving. The other three members each get their own developed persona, backstory, voice, and visual identity for the documentary series.

Member	Role	Persona angle
Sammy Rane	Frontman / songwriter	Early 30s, Seymour Indiana, sober, wounded, the voice
Drummer	Road dog / engine	50s, oldest friend, the one who's seen everything
Bassist	Bass / future spinoff	Late 20s, Sammy's cousin, the next generation
Lead guitarist	The quiet weapon	30s, female, brings tension and energy without romance plot

Genre + sonic identity

Modern post-grunge / alt-rock. Reference points: Pearl Jam (Dark Matter / Yield era), Manchester Orchestra, Highly Suspect, Cage the Elephant. Big choruses. Raw production. Vocal-forward mix. Real drums, real bass, no synth-pop polish. The voice is locked across the entire catalog via Suno Persona — every song sounds like the same singer.

Visual world

Dim rooms, rain, neon at the edges. Indiana farmland fading into Indianapolis bars fading into the drive west on I-70 fading into Echo Park and Silver Lake LA. Rust and reinvention. Practical wardrobe — denim, flannel, leather, nothing costume-y. Cinematic but never glossy.

The format — serialized rockumentary fiction

Weekly 3-minute episodes on Reels, TikTok, and YouTube Shorts revealing Sammy's backstory and the band's current 'life.' Songs released to Spotify as story moments — the song from Episode 6 drops to DSPs the week Episode 6 airs. Audience invests in the people. Songs become story beats. Like Daisy Jones & The Six meets Spinal Tap, AI-native, weekly.

05 · PRODUCTION

The Sammy Rane Tool Stack

Every tool, every role, every cost. Total stack runs ~\$250/month. No human actors, no human demo singers, no studio rentals.

Tool	Role	Cost/mo	Who runs it
Suno Pro	Song generation + Persona voice lock	\$30	Dan + UG automation
Midjourney v7	Master character reference images	\$30	Dan
Kling 3.0	Video episodes with Character ID	\$50	UG automation
Google Veo 3.1	Cinematic establishing shots	\$30	UG automation
ElevenLabs	Speaking voices (4 band members)	\$22	UG
Hedra	Lip-sync Sammy to Suno vocals	\$30	UG automation
DaVinci Resolve	Final assembly, color, mix	Free	Dan
n8n	Workflow automation — the glue	\$20	UG (this is your kingdom)
Creatomate	Automated video assembly templates	\$40	UG
Buffer / Later	Multi-platform scheduling	\$20	UG automation
DistroKid	DSP distribution	\$23/yr	UG
Songtrust	Publishing royalties	\$100/yr	UG
Identifyy	YouTube Content ID	Free	UG

The secret weapons

Suno Persona: Locks Sammy's singing voice across every song forever. Same voice on every track. No human demo singer needed. **Kling Character ID:** Locks Sammy's face and the band's faces across every video — solves the AI consistency problem that killed earlier AI bands. **Hedra:** Lip-syncs Sammy's face to Suno vocals so we can show him 'singing' the songs in episodes. **n8n:** Connects all 14 tools into one workflow — this is your masterpiece.

06 · PIPELINE

Sammy Rane Production Flow

End-to-end. From a story beat in Dan's head to a multi-platform release. UG automates everything in the orange boxes.

[DAN — CREATIVE]

Story beat or song idea — written in the Westbound bible



[DAN — CREATIVE]

Lyrics drafted by Dan (Suno-ready format, 18 lines, 2:45)



[AUTOMATED]

Suno generation via API — 4 variations using locked Sammy Persona



[DAN — CREATIVE]

Dan picks the keeper, optional revision pass



[DAN — CREATIVE]

Midjourney v7 — character reference + scene boards (Dan's eye)



[AUTOMATED]

Kling 3.0 — video episodes generated with Character ID



[AUTOMATED]

Veo 3.1 — cinematic establishing shots (Indiana farmland, LA freeways)



[AUTOMATED]

Hedra — lip-sync Sammy's face to Suno vocals for performance shots



[AUTOMATED]

ElevenLabs — speaking voice for Sammy + 3 bandmates (interview / story scenes)



[DAN — CREATIVE]

DaVinci Resolve — final cut, color, audio mix (Dan + UG)



[AUTOMATED]

Creatomate — auto-cuts to Reels (9:16), TikTok (9:16), YouTube Short (9:16), YouTube long (16:9)



[AUTOMATED]

Buffer / Later — scheduled publish across all platforms simultaneously



[AUTOMATED]

DistroKid — song released to Spotify, Apple, Tidal, Amazon, YouTube Music on episode air date



[AUTOMATED]

Songtrust + Identifyy — publishing royalties + YouTube Content ID claims active

07 · RHYTHM

Weekly + Monthly Cadence

What we produce, every week and every month. Sustainable pace. No burnout. Built to run for 36 months.

Weekly cadence

Output	Volume / week	Platform	Who does what
Short-form rockumentary episodes	2 – 3 episodes (3 min each)	Reels, TikTok, YouTube Shorts	Dan writes / UG automates assembly
Lifestyle / B-roll posts	5 – 7 clips	All platforms	UG auto-generates from Midjourney + Kling library
Long-form YouTube cut	1 – 2 per week (10–15 min)	YouTube	Compilation of week's shorts + new content
Engagement / comment work	Daily	All platforms	Dan responds in Sammy's voice (later: VA)
Sync library uploads (Engine 1)	200 – 300 tracks	Songtradr / Pond5 / etc.	Fully automated (UG's signal engine)
YouTube faceless channel posts	5 channels × 1/day = 35	YouTube	Fully automated (UG's Creatomate pipeline)

Monthly cadence

Output	Volume / month	Notes
Sammy Rane song release to DSPs	1 – 2 songs	Timed to story beats in episodes
Big episode / mini-doc	1 (8 – 12 min)	YouTube anchor — backstory deep dives, performance films
Behind-the-scenes piece	1	Studio sessions, voice memos, songwriting process — the 'real' layer
Sync library album drop	1 – 2 themed albums	Reuses Engine 1 output, distributed via DistroKid
Playlist pitching push	Each release	Spotify editorial + 50 indie curators per song
Revenue review + dashboard sync	1 (Dan + UG, 1 hour)	Pull all earnings, retro on what's working

08 · YOUR BUILD

UG's Build Modules

Four modules. ~8–10 weeks part-time over 5 months. Then maintenance.

MODULE 1 — Sammy Rane Production Pipeline

Weeks 1–4

STACK

Suno API · Kling Character ID · Hedra · Veo 3.1 · ElevenLabs · n8n · Creatomate · Buffer API

WHAT IT DOES

The full song-to-multi-platform-release pipeline for Sammy Rane and the three bandmates. Locks character consistency across 4 personas using Kling Character ID. Automates lip-sync (Hedra) and voice generation (ElevenLabs). Routes every output through Creatomate to spit out Reels, TikTok, YouTube Short, and YouTube long versions automatically. Schedules through Buffer.

MODULE 2 — Sync Library + Signal Engine

Weeks 5–9

STACK

n8n · Claude API · Suno API · Songtradr Briefs API · Tunefind scraper · TikTok trending API · multi-platform upload

WHAT IT DOES

The signal-driven sync factory. Daily scraping of live demand (briefs, trending sounds, recent placements). Claude converts signals to Suno prompts. Auto-generation and metadata tagging. Multi-platform upload (Songtradr, Pond5, AudioJungle). Brief auto-submission within 24 hours of brief posting. The crown jewel — this is your portfolio piece.

MODULE 3 — YouTube Faceless Channel Automation

Weeks 10–11

STACK

Creatomate · YouTube Data API · Identifyy · Midjourney visual library

WHAT IT DOES

Five themed channels each auto-publishing daily long-form videos. Creatomate templates stitch tracks + visual loops. YouTube API handles upload, metadata, thumbnails, scheduling. Identifyy monitors Content ID claims. Dashboard surfaces top performers.

MODULE 4 — Master Dashboard

Ongoing weeks 6+

STACK

Retool or Next.js · Supabase · DistroKid API · Songtrust scraper · YouTube Analytics API · Stripe

WHAT IT DOES

Single pane of glass. Revenue by channel. Track-level performance. Pipeline status. Error monitoring. Content calendar. Earnings splits computed automatically for the LLC. This is how we run the business.

09 · WHY YOU

Why This Is The Build of Your Career

You are not being hired. You are being offered co-founder equity in a real LLC with a real product, real revenue projections, and real creative ambition. Here is what you actually walk away with.

Equity and economics

STRUCTURE: Westbound Studios LLC — Dan Poore creates the entity.

EQUITY: **50/50 partners from day one.**

YEAR 1 PROFIT SPLIT: Dan 60% / UG 40% — Dan recoups pre-build investment.

YEAR 2 AND FOREVER: **50/50 of gross profit. Forever.**

WHAT THIS MEANS IN DOLLARS:

Year 1 (your 40%): \$12K – \$30K

Year 2 (your 50%): \$50K – \$100K+

Year 3 (your 50%): \$100K – \$500K+

Plus permanent equity in everything we build going forward.

What you actually learn (and ship)

- **AI orchestration at scale** — 14+ tools integrated through n8n into one cohesive production pipeline. The kind of system most engineers only read about.
- **Character consistency in AI video** — Kling Character ID + Hedra lip-sync + Midjourney master refs for 4 personas. This is the bleeding edge of generative video in 2026.
- **Multi-modal pipeline engineering** — text » audio » image » video » distribution, end-to-end automation. Resume-defining work.
- **Real production traffic** — Not a side project that dies. A revenue-generating system shipping thousands of tracks and dozens of episodes.
- **Co-founder credit** — When this works, you are not 'the engineer who helped' — you are the co-founder. Forever in the company history.
- **Portfolio that talks** — Every job you ever apply to after this opens with 'I co-built an AI music label with one creative partner that generated \$X over Y years.' That sentence opens every door.

Why you specifically

You are the only person Dan trusts to build this. Waterloo CS + business double major. Hands-on with n8n, APIs, automation. Sharp enough to take a vague creative brief and turn it into a working system. Young enough to grind through the build phase. Strategic enough to think about the business beside the code. Honest enough to push back when something doesn't make sense. There is no replacement. This brief does not exist without you.

10 · NEXT

What Happens Next

Immediate decisions (this week)

- Read this brief. Push back on anything that doesn't fit how you think.
- Confirm interest in the 50/50 partnership structure.
- Dan files Westbound Studios LLC paperwork (Delaware or Indiana — TBD).
- Operating agreement drafted with 50/50 equity, Year 1 60/40 split, governance.
- First architecture sketch from UG on Module 1 (Sammy Rane pipeline) — what gets built first, where the dependencies are.

Open questions for UG

- **Hosting:** n8n self-hosted on a VPS (cheaper, more control) or n8n Cloud (faster setup)?
- **Database:** Supabase or Postgres on Railway for the catalog, signal data, dashboard backend?
- **Dashboard:** Retool (faster to ship) or Next.js + Supabase (more control, more learning)?
- **Storage:** Cloudflare R2 or S3 for WAV/video assets — preferences?
- **Auth + secrets:** 1Password Business shared vault for all API keys?
- **Repo + monorepo:** One repo for all modules, or split per engine?
- **Time commitment:** Realistic weekly hours UG can commit in months 1–6?
- **Classmate help:** Open to bringing in 1–2 Waterloo classmates for specific sub-projects (with paid hourly, not equity)?

CLOSING THOUGHT — FROM DAN

I've spent 25 years building businesses. I've never had infrastructure like this available before. AI music is real, AI video consistency is real, and the audience for serialized fiction music acts is real. The only question is whether the right two people show up for the next three years and actually build it.

I'll bring the songs, the story, the strategy, and 25 years of operational pattern recognition. You bring the build, the systems thinking, and the technical chops to turn what's in my head into something that runs while we sleep.

50/50, day one. Let's go build it.